

and solving the mystery of his disappearance. Afterwards, she completed her tour of Concordia, but instead of returning to Tara-Nar, she established her court in the Kingdom of Willows, where she felt safe.

With David missing, the nation entered a tumultuous period that threatened to cast Concordia back into civil war. Numerous minor factions promoted largely unknown individuals, and in some instances even commoners, to take the throne. Princess Lenore, a House Dougal noble that David named heir apparent in the late 1980s, received support from Queen Mab, who feared that years at David's side made Regent Morwen unwilling to surrender the throne to the young ward. Both Morwen and Mab refused to acknowledge Faerilyth as High Queen, and Mab insisted that Faerilyth was involved with David's disappearance. Morwen, on the other hand, refused to surrender the throne to Lenore because of her fierce love for her brother, stating that there would only be a new ruler when, and if, David was proven dead. With three queens and one throne, the nation splintered within both Seelie and Unseelie Courts.

Numerous debates followed in the Parliament of Dreams, but the more they discussed, the more fragmented the political body became. For a time, the commoners and nobles successfully held the Parliament together, but the increasing number of physical conflicts in the chamber, and fewer members attending sessions, eventually led High Lord Ariadne to dissolve the institution for an indefinite amount of time.

In an eerie mimicry of the Resurgence, when the moon landing inspired hope around the world, came the horrifying events of September 11, 2001. In their wake, the Dreaming echoed with nightmare magic, washing over realms with the power of a massive tide, unlocking gateways and pathways to ancient prisons unseen and unvisited since before the Sundering. Trods once again opened across the world as waves of Thallain, Dark-Kin, and their minions entered the Autumn world to prepare it for the return of their masters.

Without warning, the sky seemingly ripped open and, to those with faerie sight, a red sun appeared, bathing the world in a sinister scarlet light reminiscent of blood. Scholars named it the Eye of Balor, recorded in a few tomes as belonging to one of the Fomorians imprisoned in the Dreaming. Fearing that the Elder Dark would return, or that the eye did in fact herald the Long Winter, panic erupted among the Kithain. Though this second sun vanished a week later, its presence scarred changeling society as the most violent among them adopted a vicious, devil-may-care attitude. Redcaps and Unseelie fae of all kiths bore down on Arcadian sidhe as if the Accordance War still raged. Others fought to establish friendly contacts in the face of grave danger, but no matter what, civil war seemed unavoidable as the throne of Tara-Nar remained empty.

During the early autumn of 2005, High Lord Ariadne, following a request by Sir Seif, convened the Parliament of Dreams for the first time in years. All contenders to the throne arrived,

